



**The Saka show:** Bukayo Saka smashes home the winner against Atlético Madrid in their second-leg clash. REUTERS

Now, Al Nassr must avoid defeat in its final league-stage match against Damac on May 21 to lift the title.

#### **A French-English affair in Hungary**

After 20 long years, Arsenal reached the final of UEFA Champions League after edging Atletico Madrid 2-1 on aggregate in the semifinals. The tie was finely poised after penalty strikes from Viktor Gyokeres and Julian Alvarez in the first leg left everything to play for in the return fixture. In front of the home crowd, Arsenal's star boy Bukayo Saka turned poacher just before half-time and struck from close range. The scoreline remained unchanged thereafter and the final whistle sent Arsenal fans and players into rapture.

In the other semifinal, the first leg between defending champion Paris Saint-Germain and Bayern Munich was a nine-goal thriller in which the Parisians won 5-4. That night at the Parc des Princes, Khvicha Kvaratskhelia and Ousmane Dembele scored braces, while Joao Neves also found the net. For Bayern, Harry Kane, Michael Olise, Dayot Upamecano and Luis Diaz were on target.

A 1-1 draw in the second leg was enough for PSG to book a second consecutive final appearance. Dembele smashed Kvaratskhelia's pass into the roof of the net to extend his side's aggregate lead. Kane struck in the 90+4th minute in typical fox-in-the-box fashion, but it proved too little too late. PSG sealed a 6-5 aggregate win and set up a summit clash against the Gunners in Budapest.

If one looks at previous meetings between Arsenal and PSG in the

Champions League, the contests haven't really been one-sided. The English side has one win to PSG's two, with two other matches ending in draws. Their most recent meeting came in last season's semifinals, where PSG triumphed 3-1 on aggregate.

While PSG will have less pressure to perform, Arsenal will carry the heavier burden. Much could also depend on whether the Gunners manage to stave off Manchester City in the Premier League title race, which appears headed for a final-day showdown on May 24.

#### **Bruno enters history books**

United captain Bruno Fernandes etched his name into Premier League history after becoming just the third player to register 20 assists in a single season.

He joined Thierry Henry (2002-03) and Kevin De Bruyne (2019-20) after setting up Bryan Mbeumo's goal